

RESUME WRITING TIPS

Create an Impressive Resume That Stands Out

RESOURCE	DETAIL
Purpose	Placement & fresher resume preparation
Focus	ATS-friendly • Recruiter-friendly • 1-page strategy
Coverage	Structure • Projects • Skills • Achievements • Keywords
Examples	Strong vs weak bullets + ready-to-use templates
Format	Colorful, clean and print-friendly PDF

Golden rule: Your resume is not a biography. It is a one-page evidence document showing why a recruiter should move you to the next stage.

For campus placements: Prioritize education, technical skills, strong projects, internships/experience, achievements and relevant certifications. Remove low-value filler.

1. IDEAL RESUME STRUCTURE

Section	What to include	Priority
Header	Name, phone, professional email, LinkedIn, GitHub/portfolio	Essential
Summary / Objective	2–3 lines targeted to the role	Optional for freshers
Education	Degree, college, graduation year, CGPA/percentage	High
Technical Skills	Languages, frameworks, databases, tools	High
Projects	2–3 strongest projects with impact and technologies	Very High
Experience / Internship	Role, company, dates, measurable contribution	Very High
Achievements	Rank, coding contests, scholarships, measurable accomplishments	High
Certifications	Relevant, credible certifications	Medium
Positions / Activities	Leadership or meaningful responsibility	Optional

Fresher rule: If you have limited work experience, your projects become your evidence of engineering ability. Describe what you built, how you built it, and what changed because of it.

2. HEADER & CONTACT INFORMATION

Recommended header

Aaham Kumar Arya	← Full name, visually prominent
B.Tech Computer Science Engineering	← Optional subtitle
+91 XXXXX XXXXX aaham@example.com	← Professional contact
linkedin.com/in/aaham-kumar-arya	← LinkedIn
github.com/yourusername portfolio.example.com	← GitHub / portfolio

Include: professional email • phone number • LinkedIn • GitHub • portfolio if strong.

Avoid: full postal address • father's/mother's name • religion • marital status • photo unless explicitly required • unnecessary personal information.

3. PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY / OBJECTIVE

A good summary answers three questions: **Who are you? What can you do? What role are you targeting?**

Weak	"I am a hardworking student looking for a challenging opportunity where I can grow."
Better	"B.Tech CSE student with hands-on experience building full-stack web applications using React"
Best practice	Add evidence when possible: project scale, coding achievement, internship, relevant specialization

Do not write a generic career objective. Tailor the summary to the role: frontend, backend, full stack, Java developer, data analyst, cloud engineer, etc.

4. TECHNICAL SKILLS

Category	Example
Languages	Java, JavaScript, Python, SQL
Frontend	HTML, CSS, React, Angular, Tailwind CSS
Backend	Node.js, Express, Spring Boot
Database	MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB
Tools	Git, GitHub, VS Code, Postman
Cloud / DevOps	AWS, Docker, CI/CD — only if you can discuss them
Concepts	DSA, OOP, DBMS, OS, Computer Networks, REST APIs

Important: Do not list 20 technologies just to make the skills section look large. If you cannot explain a technology in an interview, remove it or move it to a lower-priority category.

ATS tip: Use the exact terminology from the job description when it truthfully matches your experience.

5. PROJECTS — THE MOST IMPORTANT SECTION FOR FRESHERS

For a fresher, projects can demonstrate practical engineering ability more effectively than a long list of courses.

Weak bullet	Strong bullet
"Made a student portal using React."	"Built a role-based student portal using React and Node.js with authentication."
"Used MySQL database."	"Designed normalized MySQL tables for users, applications and jobs."
"Made responsive UI."	"Developed responsive interfaces for desktop and mobile using reusable components."
"Added login feature."	"Implemented JWT-based authentication with protected API routes."

Project formula: Action + Technology + What you built + Engineering detail + Result/scale.

6. ACTION VERBS & BULLET WRITING

Instead of	Use
Made / Did	Built, Developed, Implemented, Created
Worked on	Developed, Engineered, Contributed to, Delivered
Helped	Supported, Automated, Improved, Optimized
Used	Leveraged, Integrated, Implemented
Fixed	Resolved, Debugged, Refactored
Learned	Applied, Implemented, Built using
Responsible for	Owned, Led, Managed, Delivered

Bullet rule: Start with a strong verb. Explain what you changed or delivered. Add a number when it is real and defensible.

7. QUANTIFY YOUR ACHIEVEMENTS

Without evidence	With evidence
Improved website performance.	Reduced API response time from 900 ms to 500 ms by optimizing database
Built a placement portal.	Developed a role-based placement portal supporting 3 user roles and 15+ w
Solved coding problems.	Solved 250+ DSA problems across arrays, strings, trees and graphs.
Led a team.	Coordinated a 4-member team to deliver the project within the planned dea
Improved UI.	Built 12 responsive screens and standardized reusable components across

Never invent numbers. Only quantify things you can explain and defend during an interview.

8. ATS-FRIENDLY RESUME GUIDELINES

- Use standard headings such as Education, Skills, Projects, Experience, Certifications and Achievements.
- Use simple one-column formatting for the safest ATS parsing.
- Use common fonts such as Arial, Calibri, Helvetica or Times New Roman.
- Use keywords that genuinely match the job description.
- Use normal text instead of putting important information inside images.
- Avoid decorative graphics, progress bars, skill stars, logos and complex multi-column layouts when ATS compatibility is important.
- Do not hide keywords in white text or use keyword stuffing.
- Keep dates, job titles and organization names consistent.
- Export the final resume to PDF unless the employer requests another format.
- Check the PDF by selecting/copying text. If text cannot be selected normally, the file may be image-based.

ATS reality: ATS behavior varies by software and configuration. A simple, text-based resume is generally safer than a highly designed graphic resume.

9. EDUCATION SECTION

Recommended	Example
Degree	B.Tech in Computer Science & Engineering
Institution	College / University Name
Graduation	Expected 2027
Academic metric	CGPA: 8.54 / 10
Relevant coursework	DSA, OOP, DBMS, OS, Computer Networks — only if useful

For freshers: Education can appear near the top because academic performance is still relevant. As professional experience grows, experience should usually receive more space.

10. CERTIFICATIONS & ACHIEVEMENTS

Include certifications when they are relevant and credible.

Strong	Why it helps
AWS certification for a cloud role	Directly relevant to the job
Java / SQL / cloud certification with assessment	Shows validated knowledge
Recognized coding competition rank	Provides measurable evidence
Scholarship / academic award	Shows achievement
Hackathon finalist/winner	Shows practical problem solving

Avoid certificate dumping: Ten low-value course certificates are usually weaker than two highly relevant certifications plus strong projects.

11. ONE-PAGE FRESHER RESUME TEMPLATE

YOUR NAME	Phone Email LinkedIn GitHub Portfolio
SUMMARY	2–3 lines targeted to the role. Mention core stack + strongest evidence.
EDUCATION	B.Tech CSE University CGPA Expected Graduation Year
TECHNICAL SKILLS	Languages Frontend Backend Database Tools Concepts
PROJECT 1	Project name + stack • Built ... • Implemented ... • Improved/achieved ...
PROJECT 2	Project name + stack • Developed ... • Integrated ... • Added ...
INTERNSHIP / EXPERIENCE	Company Role Dates • Delivered ... • Optimized ... • Collaborated ...
ACHIEVEMENTS	Coding rank Hackathon Academic award Leadership
CERTIFICATIONS	Certification Issuer Year

Space-saving rule: Keep only the strongest 2–3 projects. Remove repetitive descriptions and low-value coursework.

12. TOP RESUME MISTAKES TO AVOID

1. Spelling or grammar errors.
2. Using an unprofessional email address.
3. Writing a generic objective for every job.
4. Listing skills you cannot explain in an interview.
5. Using huge paragraphs instead of concise bullets.
6. Describing responsibilities without outcomes.
7. Using fake or exaggerated numbers.
8. Adding irrelevant personal information.
9. Using too many colors, icons or graphics.
10. Using a multi-column template that breaks ATS parsing.
11. Making the resume longer than necessary.
12. Copying project descriptions from the internet.
13. Adding every certificate instead of the most relevant ones.
14. Not including GitHub/project links when the projects are genuinely worth showing.
15. Sending the same resume to every job without tailoring keywords.

13. TAILOR YOUR RESUME TO THE JOB DESCRIPTION

- ✓ Extract the required skills from the job description.
- ✓ Separate must-have skills from nice-to-have skills.
- ✓ Move relevant projects and skills higher.
- ✓ Use the job description's terminology when accurate.
- ✓ Rewrite 2–4 project bullets to emphasize relevant experience.
- ✓ Remove irrelevant technologies and filler.
- ✓ Check that your summary matches the role.
- ✓ Review the final PDF for ATS readability.

Example: If a job emphasizes Java + Spring Boot + SQL, your Java/Spring/SQL project should be prominent. Do not lead with unrelated technologies simply because you know them.

14. FINAL RESUME CHECKLIST

- ✓ Name and contact details are correct.
- ✓ Professional email address is used.
- ✓ LinkedIn and GitHub links work.
- ✓ Portfolio link works if included.
- ✓ Education details are accurate.
- ✓ CGPA/percentage is accurate and consistently formatted.
- ✓ Skills are truthful and interview-ready.
- ✓ Projects show your contribution, not just project names.
- ✓ At least one project has meaningful technical depth.
- ✓ Bullets begin with strong action verbs.
- ✓ Achievements are quantified where possible.
- ✓ Resume is tailored to the target role.
- ✓ Keywords match the job description where truthful.
- ✓ No spelling or grammar errors.
- ✓ No unnecessary personal information.
- ✓ Formatting is consistent throughout.
- ✓ Resume is preferably one page for a typical fresher campus application.
- ✓ PDF text can be selected/copied normally.
- ✓ File name is professional, e.g. FirstName_LastName_Resume.pdf.

Final rule: Every line on your resume should earn its space. If a recruiter asks “So what did you actually do?”, your bullet should already contain the evidence.